

Newsletter

Measurement Is The New Black

Highlights of this quarter :

Upcoming Events

October 5, 2026 – Eiko Fried to be inaugurated as a Full Professor ([link](#))

University of Leiden, the Netherlands; Professor of Mental Health and Data Science

Inaugural lecture: "**Systems All the Way Down: Rethinking Mental Health Science as a Systems Science**"



April 21-23, 2027 – Small is Beautiful Conference ([website](#) | [announcement](#))

The international "Small is Beautiful" congresses and symposia are organised once every 2 or 3 years by Single Case Design (SCD) experts from different universities worldwide, with the aim to demonstrate SCD as a broad, multidisciplinary methodology. The "Small is Beautiful {4ever}" congress in 2027 will be the fourth in line.

Paper Highlight

See this ESM article, started at the 2024 MITNB hackathon and recently published in Nature Communication Psychology, by Bringmann et al.: "**Experience sampling methods require more than numbers**". Congrats team!

Call for Input/Collaboration – contact Yannick Morvan, Université Paris Nanterre — ymorvan@parisnanterre.fr

A Mixed-Methods Study on Student Mental Health and Help-Seeking in France

This project builds on two national surveys by the French National Observatory of Student Life (OVE): CdV23 (2023; 49,523 students, psychological distress and health service use) and BSE24 (2024; 5,676 re-interviewed with an expanded battery, including PHQ-9, GAD-7, CIDI-SF, suicidal ideation, plus detailed help-seeking data). Our team leads the qualitative follow-up: ~30 in-depth interviews and 5-6 focus groups (September-December 2026) with participants drawn from BSE24. **Core questions:** (1) What subjective, symbolic, and structural mechanisms explain patterns of non-help seeking, delayed help-seeking, or treatment discontinuation? (2) How do students interpret their psychological difficulties, and how does this shape their help-seeking pathways? (3) What role do structural factors and stigma play in these trajectories? **Why I'm reaching out to MITNB:** For collaboration & help! How do respondents make sense of their own quantitative scores? When a student exceeds a clinical threshold on PHQ-9/GAD-7, does that match their lived experience? If not, what does the mismatch tell us about validity, self-perception, or help-seeking? What would you want the interviews to explore, and which constructs or discrepancies seem most important to probe? Contact us to exchange ideas or for more structured involvement.

ECR Spotlight : Björn Siepe

Bio: Björn recently defended his PhD in Psychological Methods at the Philipps-Universität Marburg. His research focuses on three areas: time series modelling, metascience of methodological research, and applied experience sampling research. He is broadly interested in understanding how we can better model intensive longitudinal data, and how we can make methodological research more robust and transparent. Björn tries to build open-source tools that are useful for the field, such as software packages (e.g., the recently published R package [VARcheck](#) for model checking of VAR models) or the [openESM](#) database of harmonized, openly available ESM datasets cited below.

Representative paper:

Siepe, B. S., Haslbeck, J. M. B., Kloft, M., Büchner, A., Zhang, Y., Fried, E. I., & Heck, D. W. (2025, October 22). Introducing openESM: A database of openly available experience sampling datasets.

https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qfdtb_v1



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<https://bsiepe.github.io/>



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